

Design Guidelines

How to create and deliver a design for a MONO tee: one ink, black or white cotton, printed large on the back. Everything you need to make a design that prints well and passes our review first time.

01 What we print

- **One ink.** Every design is printed in a single colour. No second colour, no gradients, no grey. Tones are made with dots or lines (halftone, hatching, stippling).
- **On the back.** The print sits high on the back of the tee, centred.
- **Black and white tees.** A design is offered on a black tee (printed in white ink) and on a white tee (printed in black ink). If your design only works on one of them, tell us.

What makes a good **MONO** design: strong line work, clear shapes and plenty of air. Think engraving, botanical plate, map, diagram, woodcut, typography, pattern, or a photograph turned into dots. The tee's colour is part of the design: leave room for it to show.

02 Print area and placement

ITEM	SIZE
Full print area	28 × 37 cm (width × height)
Recommended design size	Up to 26 × 35 cm, leaving a margin inside the area
Small placement (optional)	12 × 12 cm square
Position	Centred left to right. The top of the design starts about 1 cm below the top of the print area

- Align your design to the **top** of the area, not the middle. Don't leave a large empty band above it.
- The design should be substantial: at least **30% of the width and 30% of the height** of the print area. A thin strip across the chest or down the spine won't be accepted.

03 Files

Line art, type, geometry and patterns: vector (preferred)

- SVG, with a PDF or AI copy.
- One colour only (100% black). Transparent background, with no background rectangle.
- All text converted to outlines.
- No embedded images, gradients, transparency, effects, shadows or complex masks.
- Artboard: 28 × 37 cm, the print area.

Photographs, engravings, brush and scanned work: raster

- PNG with a transparent background.

- 300 DPI at print size: 3307 × 4370 px for the full area, 1417 × 1417 px for the small placement.
- 1-bit (ink or nothing), or greyscale that has **already been screened** into dots or lines. A continuous-tone greyscale photo cannot be printed in one ink.

Two tee colours

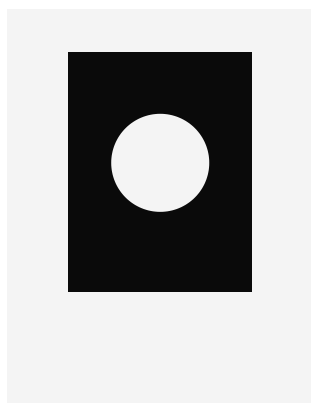
- **Line art:** one file is enough. We print it in white on black tees and in black on white tees.
- **Photographs and any tonal work:** send two positives, because inverting a photo inverts its meaning:
 - ...-black.png: what prints in **white** ink on a black tee (the light parts of the picture are the ink);
 - ...-white.png: what prints in **black** ink on a white tee.

04 Ink: how much, and where

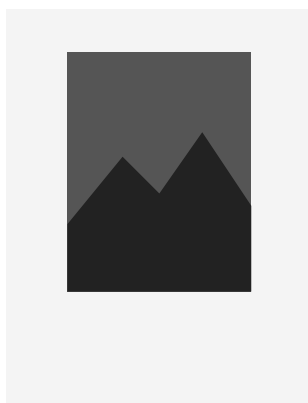
Every design is checked for these before it goes on sale. A design that fails is returned with the reason.

RULE	LIMIT
Total ink coverage	Between 4% and 32% of the print area
Solid ink	Areas of solid ink wider than about 4 mm may cover no more than 10% of the area in total, and no single solid patch more than 3%
Rectangles and panels	No filled rectangle, panel or box of ink, and no full background with the motif cut out of it (knockout)
Photographs	The subject cut out, or faded to nothing at the edges: never the whole photo with its background
Edges	Ink must not run along all four edges of the print area
Frames and paper	No dark vignette around an empty middle, no scanned paper edges or shadows

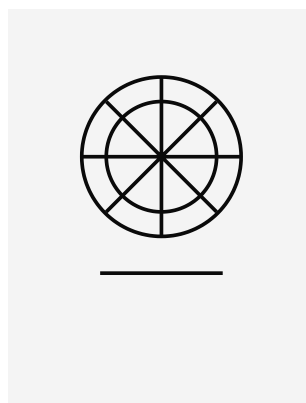
The simple test: if your design lands on the tee as a *rectangle of ink*, like a sticker, it won't pass. Open line work, dotted halftones, thin frames around line grids and cut-out subjects all pass.



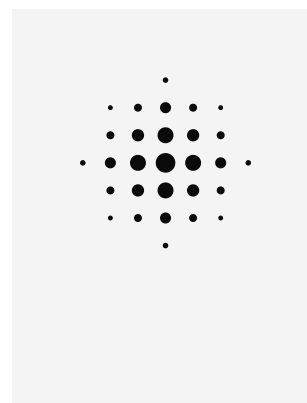
× Knockout panel



× Photo with its background



✓ Open line work



✓ Halftone fading out

05 Lines, dots and text

ELEMENT	MINIMUM / RECOMMENDED
Line weight	Minimum 0.4 mm (thinner lines don't print reliably). A good hierarchy: 0.5 / 0.75 / 1.1 / 1.7 mm for hairline, fine, regular and bold
Halftone dots and the gaps between them	Minimum 0.4 mm
Text: capital height	Minimum 2.5 mm; 4 mm or more for text that must be read
Small detail	Any enclosed detail smaller than 0.4 mm will fill in when printed: simplify it

06 Words and type

- **Fonts:** only fonts licensed for commercial use on products (for example, SIL Open Font License). Tell us the font and its licence.
- **Language:** British English (colour, centre, metres). Typographic apostrophes and quotation marks (' " "), not straight ones (' ").
- **Not allowed:** brand names, logos, trademarks, copyrighted quotes or lyrics, and names of private individuals.

07 Rights

- Your own original work, or material in the **public domain** or under **CC0**. Licences that require attribution or forbid commercial use only by prior agreement.
- For archive material (museum and library collections), include the link to the source, the item number, the creator, the date and the licence.
- Photographs of people only with a model release, or when the photograph is in the public domain.
- Images made with generative tools: tell us which tool, and confirm its terms allow commercial use.
- By submitting, you confirm you have the right to grant **MONO** the rights to print and sell the design.

08 Details for each design

FIELD	WHAT TO WRITE
Title	In English, up to 40 characters, Title Case. Example: "The Fourteen Eight-Thousanders"
Category	One of: Photographs · Botanical & Nature · Maps & Sky · Architecture · Engravings · Brush & Woodblock · Pattern · Geometric · Type · ASCII & Code
Subject	What it shows, in a word or two. Example: Mountains
Style	Example: Halftone, Line drawing, Woodcut
Medium	Drawn (vector or illustration), photograph or scan
Description	One or two sentences in British English: what we see and where it comes from
Tee colours	Black, white, or both
Print size	The design's actual width × height in cm
Keywords	5 to 10 search words
Credit and source	Source and licence, where relevant

09 Delivery

One folder per design, zipped. File names in English, lower case, words joined by hyphens, no spaces.

<code>yourname-short-title/</code>	
<code>short-title.svg</code>	(or <code>short-title-black.png</code> + <code>short-title-white.png</code>)
<code>short-title-preview.png</code>	1500 px wide, the design on a black or white background
<code>short-title.txt</code>	the details from section 08
<code>sources/</code>	source files and licences, where relevant

10 Checklist before you submit

- ☐ One colour, transparent background, no gradients or grey
- ☐ Artboard 28 × 37 cm, design up to 26 × 35 cm, aligned to the top
- ☐ Vector with text outlined, or PNG at 300 DPI (3307 × 4370 px)
- ☐ Tonal work: two positives, -black and -white
- ☐ Ink coverage between 4% and 32%; no rectangles, panels or full backgrounds
- ☐ Lines and dots at least 0.4 mm; capital height at least 2.5 mm
- ☐ Fonts and materials licensed for commercial use, sources included
- ☐ All details from section 08 filled in